COMMETRIC

ULTIMATE GUIDE TO MEDIA MONITORING



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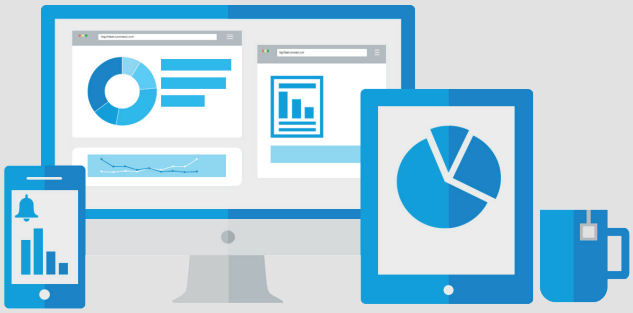
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CHAPTER 1:
MEDIA MONITORING

OVERVIEW

Comprehensive media monitoring includes daily or weekly synopsis of relevant media (print, broadcast, online). It offers the ability to stay abreast of media coverage and ahead of any potential issues as they arise in media. Measurement and evaluation are particularly important tools for quantifying PR efforts and results, and enticing corporate sponsorship.



Media monitoring suppliers provide some or all of the following core services:

- Monitoring and reporting of relevant media set;
- Daily delivery of media results in an electronic report;
- An online platform/portal encompassing all relevant media coverage searchable by keywords or other target criteria;
- An online platform/portal including comprehensive coverage details i.e. links, full-page colour PDFs, story summaries, broadcast notes etc.;
- An evaluation tool that can generate analysis reports and charts that account for ad value, circulation/audience reach, geographic region, tone, media type etc.;
- A media database service with wide-ranging search functions that allows the user to find media contacts.

Services may include:

Media Database

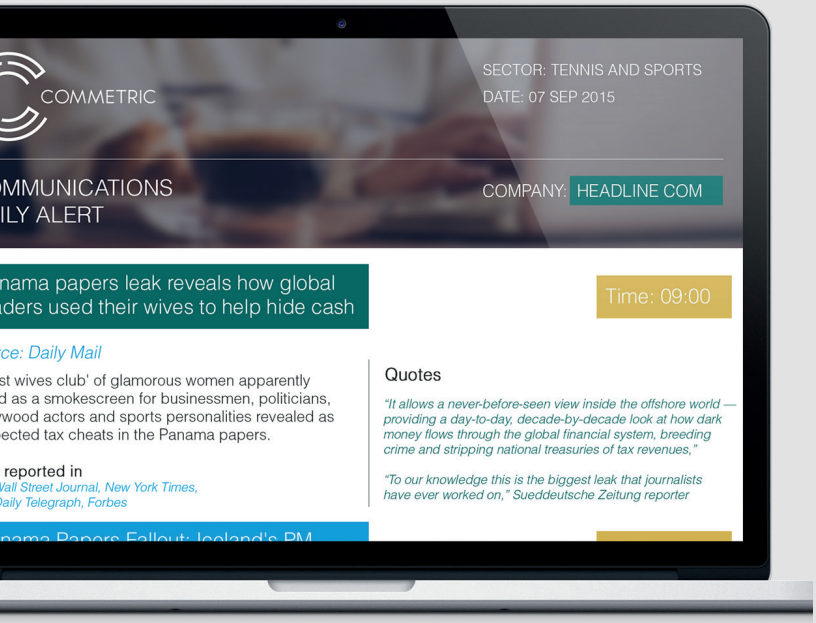
Print Media Monitoring

Broadcast Media Monitoring

Online Media Monitoring

COMMON CHALLENGES AND BEST PRACTICE

- **Timeliness**
  Consistently delivering reports by 9 am is critical and can be a challenge for some suppliers.
- **Well-written synopses**
  Some suppliers simply just copy and paste articles, which may pose copyright issues.
- **Relevancy**
  Analysts read through the noise and ensure alerts focus on highly relevant coverage.
- **Time Zone coverage**
  Does the supplier cover your business in the needed time zones?
- **Multiple daily reports**
  Many companies require a morning and an afternoon report.
- **Mobile-friendly**
  Many executives like to receive the morning report via mobile to review on their way into work.
- **Embargo times**
  Some publications have embargo times which can delay reports.
- **No evaluation**
  Some clients believe monitoring can replace evaluation – it can't.
- **Languages**
  In a global market place, an English synopsis of foreign media is the standard.



BENEFITS

- Early warning
- Filters media to deliver relevant intelligence
- Senior executives informed 24/7

CHAPTER 2:
CRISIS ALERTS



OVERVIEW

Responding to an emerging issue identified in a daily monitoring report, clients receive a crisis report within set timeframe after the story breaking.

COMMON CHALLENGES AND BEST PRACTICE

- Speed of delivery

  First crisis report needs to be produced within 5 hours of the crisis happening.

- Historical benchmark

  Emerging issues should be analysed in a historical context with 12 months-10 years issue trend.

- Competitive benchmark

  Understanding how the crisis is impacting competitors is critical to formulating an appropriate rebuttal strategy.

- Crisis topic analysis

  Understanding what topics are making up the crisis and assessing how the topics are being played out in the media is critical to formulating a strategy.

- Top reporters and publications

  Understanding which publications and journalists are driving the media coverage is critical to reputable planning.



BENEFITS

- Quick & effective crisis rebuttal
- Better crisis strategy

CHAPTER 3:
WEEKLY MEDIA ROUND-UP

OVERVIEW

Comprehensive synopsis of the weekly media ranking stories and issues.

BENEFITS

- Comprehensive but short
- Vital document for executives, short on time during the week

COMMON CHALLENGES AND BEST PRACTICE

- Well written synopsis

  Some suppliers just copy and paste articles.
- Short and snappy

  Brevity is key in a weekly round up.
- Article access

  Many clients like to see actual text of important articles or blogs.
- Languages

  In a global market place, an English synopsis of foreign media is the standard.
- Breadth of media

  Comprehensive round-up should include online and offline media, trade and mainstream press.
- Competitive view

  Round-up of media impacting both the client AND competitors is important to deliver a true perspective.
- Print compatibility

  Document format should be compatible for printing.



CHAPTER 4:
CHOOSING A MONITORING PARTNER

CHECK LIST

☐ Deploys an
APPROPRIATE AND CREDIBLE METHODOLOGY

Monitoring suppliers have addressed the increase in media outlets in several ways: some suppliers have a manual approach that focuses on a few 'tier 1' influential publications; however many have developed automated text mining methodologies that can process thousands of outlets and can quantify trends from many outlets. Some suppliers bring both methodologies together.

☐ Delivers the
FULL PICTURE

The growth in media outlets has revolutionized traditional clipping-based services. New stories are channel-agnostic and will spread across media channels (TV, Radio, print, blogs etc.). Suppliers are challenged to evaluate a story across a growing number of channels to provide a full picture.

☐ Delivers
ACCURATE RESULTS

Evaluation from companies that apply a purely quantitative text mining approach will be subject to a significant level of error, or to use the industry term 'noise'. In cases where millions of articles are counted, this noise will not impact the overall trend, but where the publication set is more defined, the noise could skew the results considerably.

☐ Offers
TIMELY REPORTS

Where monitoring is of concern, it is important to deliver reports aligned with the internal meetings or reporting functions; for monitoring - daily and weekly round-ups are time critical at the start of the business day, for crisis alerts - a 24/7 basis is essential.

GETTING THE BEST FROM YOUR PARTNER

Below we present 10 ways to get the best from evaluation according to The Association for Measurement and Evaluation of Communication (AMEC).

1. SET YOUR OBJECTIVES CAREFULLY: ALL GOOD RESEARCH STARTS HERE
2. DEFINE YOUR TARGET AUDIENCES: WHO, WHEN, WHERE, AND WHY?
3. IDENTIFY YOUR KEY MESSAGES: WRITE THEM DOWN, BE CLEAR AND CONSISTENT
4. IT'S THE CONTENT THAT COUNTS: CONSIDER WHAT ISSUES AFFECT YOU AND YOUR SECTOR
5. DON'T JUST THINK ABOUT YOUR OWN COVERAGE: CONSIDER YOUR COMPETITORS TOO
6. WATCH FOR BIAS: WHEN SOURCING MATERIALS AND INTERPRETING THE RESULTS
7. DECIDE WHAT OUTPUT OR REPORT YOU NEED: NOT WHAT OTHERS WANT TO SELL YOU
8. WIN COMMITMENT AT BOARD LEVEL: GET BOARD SIGN OFF ON KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS
9. SHARE RESULTS WITH OTHER DEPARTMENTS: THEIR INTEREST MAY HELP SHARE THE BUDGET
10. USE THE RESULTS: THIS IS FOR PLANNING AND SHARING, NOT FOR SITTING ON THE SHELF.

QUESTIONS FOR YOU

- Is your media share in line with market share?
- What stories are driving your coverage?
- Are these stories the same for your competitors?
- Is your coverage rising or falling?
- What is the long term trend?
- Are the issues driving your coverage in line with your communication strategy? If not, why not?
- How does coverage align with key communication and therefore business objectives?
- Where and how can positive coverage be increased?
- Are your key messages being picked up?
- Do you have a top-tier media list? Are these being hit?
- Are these publications delivering positive coverage?
- Are these publications picking up your strategic messages?
- What tactics are your competitors deploying to improve their media profile? Do you know?
- Are your key audiences the same as those your competitors target?
- How are you positioned on industry issues? Leading or following? Does it matter?
- Do you have a leadership position for any media theme?
- How are company executives positioned in the media?
- Do executives push strategic messages effectively?
- Is your CEO more dominant in industry discussions than other CEOs? To what effect?
- What new industry trends are being talked about in the media?
- Are you associated with these new trends?
- Are you being referenced by key opinion leaders?
- Do you know who the key opinion leaders for your industry are?

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Want to know more?

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